BGIN Block #9 Meeting Report

- Rebuilding Value, Governance and Reputation on Blockchain -

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The Global Network for Blockchain Stakeholders™

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3.15. IKPWG Interactive Workshop Session 3: Token and Privacy Impact: World Coin - Biometric Information

Date: Nov 21, 2023
Time: 15:30 - 17:00
Session Chair: Iris Rad (Clyde & Co.)

1. Discussion points

- **Introduction to Worldcoin**: Introduced to the topic of privacy implications in biometric data collection and use. World Coin was introduced as a project focusing on proof of personhood using biometric information, specifically iris scanning.
- **Privacy and Ethical Concerns**: Discussed the privacy concerns related to collecting and using biometric data. Concerns from various data privacy commissions like Kenya's and France's were mentioned, highlighting the need for informed consent in data collection.
- **Technical and Security Aspects**: Discussed technicalities of the Worldcoin system, including how it uses a biometric scanning device (the orb) to scan a person’s iris and issues a unique World ID. The security of such devices and the data storage practices were questioned, especially regarding the risk of data misuse or leakage.
- **Legal and Regulatory Perspectives**: Discussed legal perspectives, emphasizing the importance of complying with privacy and data protection laws. The panel highlighted that the usage of biometrics is not impossible from a privacy point of view but requires careful consideration of laws and ethical guidelines.
- **Utility and Application of Biometric Data**: Discussed the utility of biometric data in various sectors, including its application in cybersecurity for authenticating individuals in secure systems. The need for clear value exchange and consent in biometric data use was emphasized.
- **Public Perception and Awareness**: Pointed out that public perception plays a crucial role in the acceptance of biometric technology. They discussed the importance of educating the public about the privacy implications and the responsible use of biometric data.

2. Next Steps

- Discuss how to increase public awareness and understanding of biometric data usage, in terms of transparency, education, and adherence to privacy laws and ethical standards.
- Conduct a risk assessment of the collection, storage, and use of biometric data
- Identify technical deficiencies and areas for improvement and continually update the system
- Consult with industry stakeholders, policy makers, and privacy advocacy groups to establish common standards and guidelines